Katherin Dai

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GitHub | Substack
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Education

2025-26 **Ph.D. Student | M.A.**, Economics, University of Virginia
2021-22 **M.S.**, Economics, Johns Hopkins University
2017-21 **B.S.**, Economics and Finance, Shanghai Univ. of Political Science and Law

Research Interests

Economics of Transformative AI, US-China AI Policy, and AI Infrastructure

Professional Experience

2023-25 Research Analyst, European Department, International Monetary Fund
2023-25 Research Assistant, Harvard Business School, (Advisor: Prof. Letian Zhang)
2022 Research Intern, The Brookings Institution, (Advisor: Prof. Cheng Li)
2022 Research Assistant, Econ Research Department, Institute of International Finance
2021 M&A Intern, Investment Banking Department, Guotai Haitong Securities Co., Ltd

Projects

2026 AI Hackathon, Opportunity FLOPs
Foundation for American Innovation

AI Certificates

2026 Frontier AI Governance (BlueDot Impact)

Working Paper

W1. **Dai, K.** Learning Bottlenecks in Recursive Self-Improvement. ArXiv[Preprint]. 2026.

Publications

P1. **Dai, K.**, Jarmuzek, M., Qu, R. & Rasekh, A. Enhancing Judicial System Efficiency in Greece: Drivers and Economic Impact. *IMF Selected Issues Papers* SIP/2025/057 (2025).

P2. Cots-Capell, J., Cui, L., Gomes, D., MacDonald, D., Thevenot, C. & **Dai, K.** Unlocking the Work Force Potential: Empowering Women to Boost Economic Growth and Greek Prosperity. *IMF Selected Issues Papers* SIP/2025/056 (2025).

P3. Carella, A., Chen, R., **Dai, K.**, Li, G., Lama, R. & Meeks, R. Monetary Policy Issues in the UK. *IMF Selected Issues Papers* SIP/2024/028 (2024).
– Quoted by Financial Times.

P4. Ma, G., Feng, P. & **Dai, Y.** The Great Demographic Challenge. *IIF China Spotlight Research* (2022). [pdf].

Awards & Grants

2021	Outstanding Graduate Award of Shanghai
2020	Mathematical Contest in Modeling - Meritorious Winner
2019,20	National Scholarships (RMB 16000)